

词汇: *pocket money* 零花钱

- 1 How much pocket money did you get as a child, if any? Was it a regular, weekly **allowance**, or just occasional **one-off** payments for **chores**? Parents around the world have different ideas about the **dos and don'ts** of pocket money. How much should parents give? Should they track what their children spend money on? And where is the balance between teaching children valuable life lessons and simply **spoiling** them?
- 2 Giving children pocket money offers more than just **disposable income** – it can provide lessons in **financial literacy**. One of the first things children can learn is that money is **finite** – once it is spent, there's no more until the next allowance. This awareness can help children learn how to **budget** and make good financial decisions. For example, they might spend weeks **saving up** for something big and exciting, rather than spending small amounts immediately. Making money mistakes while the amounts are relatively small can prepare children for when they start handling larger sums of money as adults.
- 3 Some parents link pocket money to household chores, teaching kids that hard work and good behaviour is rewarded. Louise Hill is the CEO of GoHenry – a money management service for children. She says that earning through chores encourages financial independence and "ultimately gives much more satisfaction rather than **instant gratification**". The downside of this, however, is that kids may only help around the house when they receive payment, rather than seeing it as their shared responsibility. In their **adolescence**, young people may transition to a more **lucrative** way of earning pocket money – part-time work such as babysitting.
- 4 Pocket money used to mean exactly that – coins or notes that children could keep in their pocket. And when they're young, seeing physical cash is a good way for them to understand money. But in today's digital world, families are increasingly going **cashless**. Online money management services are emerging in the market, many of them offering a combination of prepaid **debit cards** and an app that both child and parent can use to track spending. Some even offer **gamified** money lessons and the option to set up pots to fulfil savings goals. This modern approach is just another way children can be prepared for adult life, where many **transactions** are digital.

- 5 There's no perfect formula when it comes to pocket money, and a lot will depend on family situation and finances. Ultimately, learning to spend wisely, save and even give generously can help children build a healthy relationship with money that can continue into adulthood.

测验与练习

一、将标题和段落配对。

Paragraph 1 _____

Paragraph 2 _____

Paragraph 3 _____

Paragraph 4 _____

Paragraph 5 _____

- a. Saving pocket money
- b. Earning pocket money
- c. Pocket money teaches generosity
- d. Pocket money in the modern world
- e. The bigger picture
- f. Many factors to consider

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. In paragraph 2, what does 'it' refer to in the following sentence? *Giving children pocket money offers more than just disposable income – it can provide lessons in financial literacy.*

- a. giving children pocket money
- b. disposable income
- c. pocket money

2. Understanding that money is finite teaches children...

- a. how to spend.
- b. how to budget.
- c. how to be an adult.

3. The author thinks it's bad for children to make mistakes with money.

- a. True
- b. False
- c. Not given

4. What is the disadvantage of paying children for doing chores?

- a. They might not help around the house without payment.
- b. They might be underpaid.
- c. They might get tired.

5. Digital money management services cost money.

- a. True
- b. False
- c. Not given

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

Giving children pocket money can improve their **1)** _____. If they want to **2)** _____ for an exciting new toy, they must learn how to **3)** _____ and only buy the things they need, rather than being tempted by **4)** _____. If they want to save up faster, they must do more **5)** _____ to earn more pocket money from their parents.

save up	financial literacy	instant gratification
budget		cashless
adolescence		chores

（答案见词汇表后）

词汇表

allowance	父母定期给孩子的钱，定期补贴
one-off	一次性的
chore	家务活
dos and don'ts	应该与不应该做的事，规则
spoil	宠坏，溺爱
disposable income	可支配收入
financial literacy	财务知识，金融素养
finite	有限的
budget	制订预算
save up	存钱
instant gratification	即时满足
adolescence	青少年时期
lucrative	赚钱的
cashless	无现金的
debit card	借记卡
gamified	游戏化的
transaction	交易

答案

一、将标题和段落配对。

Paragraph 1 **f) Many factors to consider**

Paragraph 2 **a) Saving pocket money**

Paragraph 3 **b) Earning pocket money**

Paragraph 4 **d) Pocket money in the modern world**

Paragraph 5 **e) The bigger picture**

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. **a.** 'It' refers back to the phrase 'giving children pocket money'.
2. **b.** *This awareness can help children **learn how to budget** and make good financial decisions.*
3. **b. False.** *Making money mistakes while the amounts are relatively small **can prepare children** for when they start handling larger sums of money as adults.*
4. **a.** *The downside of this, however, is that **kids may only help around the house when they receive payment**, rather than seeing it as their shared responsibility.*
5. **c. Not given.** How much digital money management services cost is not mentioned.

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

Giving children pocket money can improve their **financial literacy**. If they want to **save up** for an exciting new toy, they must learn how to **budget** and only buy the things they need, rather than being tempted by **instant gratification**. If they want to save up faster, they must do more **chores** to earn more pocket money from their parents.